the Ruler and his Dewan. The democracy that prevails in Mysore at present is indistinguishable from autocracy.

If democracy is not suited to India, it appears to be equally unsuitable for Egypt. I have just read a long despatch from Cairo in the *Statesman*[1] (for this daily is supplied to me now in my present gaol). We are told that the Premier, Nessim Pasha, "has now aroused no little alarm in responsible-minded quarters owing to his declaration that he hoped to get the political parties to co-operate, especially the Wafd, and either to have a national conference or elections for a constituent assembly, in either case for the elaboration of a new Constitution. This can only mean in the end . . . a return to the régime of the popular democratic government which history shows has always been disastrous for Egypt, since in the past it has ever pandered to the worst passions of the mob. . . . No one knowing anything of the inner working of Egyptian politics and of the people, doubts for one moment that elections will again result in the return of the Wafd with a majority. Unless something is done, therefore, to prevent this procedure, we shall within a short time be again saddled with an ultra-democratic anti-foreign revolutionary régime."

It is suggested that the elections should be "run" by administrative pressure "as a counterpoise to the Wafd," but, unhappily, the Premier "has too much the legal mind" to do any such thing. The only other course that remains, we are told, is for Whitehall to intervene and to "let it be known that it will not tolerate the return of a régime" of this kind.

What steps Whitehall may or may not take, or what will happen in Egypt I do not know.[2] But this argument put forward by presumably a liberty-loving Englishman does help us to understand a little, some of the complexities of the Egyptian and Indian situation. As the *Statesman* points out in a leading article: "The root evil has been that the way of life and attitude of mind of an ordinary Egyptian voter are inharmonious with the sort of way of life and attitude of mind out of which democracy is developed." This want of harmony is illustrated further on: "In Europe, democracies have often been brought down because there were too many parties; in Egypt the difficulty has been there only being one party, the Wafd."

In India we are told that our communal divisions come in the way of our democratic progress and, therefore, with incontro-

[1] December 19, 1934.

[2] There were widespread political riots in Egypt against the British occupation in November 1935.